VINEYARD FLORENCE CHURCH

WEBSITE MANUAL

Caring For Our *Website.*

A step-by-step guide for Vineyard Florence Church staff and volunteers: how the website works, how to update it with Claude, how to publish changes with Netlify, and what to do when something goes wrong. No technical experience needed.

Vineyard Florence Church

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START HERE

How To Use This Manual

You do not need to know how to code to look after this website. You describe what you want in everyday words, an AI assistant called Claude makes the change, and you decide when it goes live.

This manual is written for anyone at Vineyard Florence Church who looks after the website. It assumes no technical background. Every technical word is explained the first time it appears, and there is a glossary at the back (Chapter 15).

If you only read one part

Read **Chapter 1 (The Big Picture)** and **Chapter 4 (Your Everyday Workflow)**. Together they cover 90% of what you will do week to week. Keep the **Quick Reference Card** on the next page handy.

How this manual is organised

- **Chapters 1–3** explain what the website is made of and get you set up.
- **Chapters 4–6** are the everyday "how do I…?" chapters, with ready-to-use wording you can copy.
- **Chapters 7–10** explain the services behind the scenes (Netlify, the forms, GitHub) and what happens automatically.
- **Chapters 11–14** cover checking your work, fixing problems, staying safe and moving the church's web address.
- **The appendices** are a page-by-page map of the website, a one-page cheat sheet of things to say to Claude, and a form for recording account details.

The boxes you will see

TIP

A shortcut or good habit that will save you time.

IMPORTANT

Something that can cause a problem if it is skipped. Read these carefully.

GOOD TO KNOW

Background that helps things make sense, but is not a step you need to take.

YOU CAN SAY

"Example wording you can type to Claude, word for word, or adapt."

SCREENS CHANGE

Claude, Netlify and GitHub update their websites from time to time. If a button in this manual has moved or been renamed, look for the closest match, or ask Claude: "Where do I find ___ in Netlify now?"

KEEP THIS HANDY

Quick Reference Card

The website's addresses

Live website	https://vineyardflorence.netlify.app (the church's own address, vineyardflorence.church, can be pointed here later — see Chapter 14)
Make changes (Claude)	https://claude.ai/code
Publishing & form messages (Netlify)	https://app.netlify.com
Where the website's files live (GitHub)	https://github.com — repository named `vineyard-florence`

Making a change, in six steps

1. **Open Claude** at claude.ai/code and start a session on the `vineyard-florence` repository.
2. **Describe the change** in plain words. Add a screenshot if it helps.
3. **Read Claude's reply** and look at any screenshots it shows you. Ask for adjustments.
4. **Group small changes together**, because each publish uses Netlify credits.
5. **Say "push to main"** when you are happy. This publishes the change.
6. **Check the live site** a few minutes later. Press **Ctrl + Shift + R** (Windows) or **Cmd + Shift + R** (Mac) to see the newest version.

If something goes wrong

- **The live site looks broken after a change:** in Netlify, open *Deploys*, click the last good version and choose *Publish deploy*. The old version is back within a minute. (Chapter 8)
- **A change is not showing:** wait 5 minutes, then hard-refresh. Still missing? Ask Claude: “Did my last change reach the live site?” (Chapter 12)
- **Form messages are not arriving:** check the form’s submissions in Netlify, then its email notification settings. (Chapter 9)

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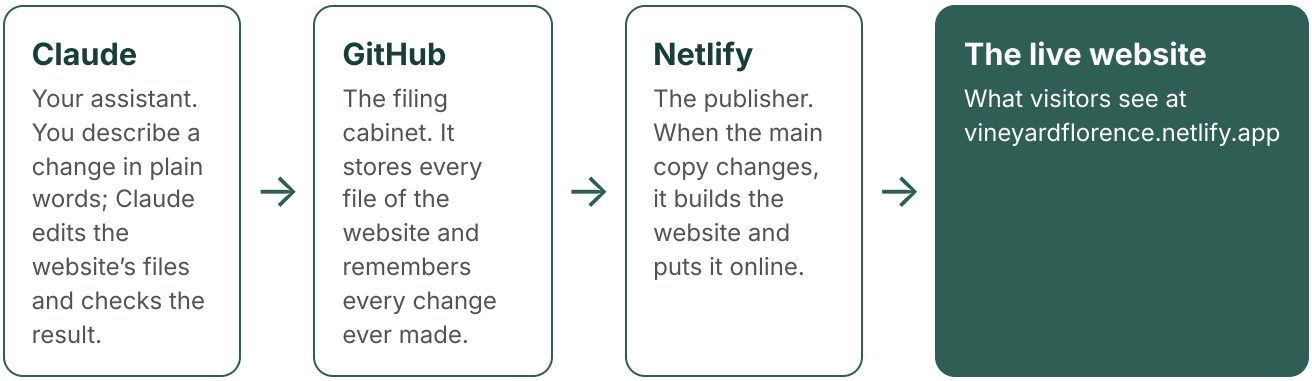
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CHAPTER 1

The Big Picture: How The Website Works

Three online services work together to run the website. You will spend most of your time in one of them (Claude), check on another now and then (Netlify), and rarely need the third (GitHub).



You talk to Claude. Claude updates GitHub. Netlify notices and publishes.

An everyday comparison

Think of the website like the church's printed bulletin:

- **GitHub** is the folder on the office computer that holds the bulletin file. It keeps every past version, so nothing is ever truly lost.
- **Claude** is a helpful volunteer who knows how to edit that file. You tell them "change the date of the men's breakfast to December 5" and they make the edit, then show you a proof.
- **Netlify** is the printer. Nothing reaches the congregation until the final version goes to the printer. Once it does, copies come out in a few minutes.

Two copies of the website: the draft and the live one

The website's files exist in more than one version at a time. These versions are called **branches**. You only need to know about two:

Branch	What it is	Who sees it
A working branch (Claude gives it a name, such as `claude/…`)	Claude's draft copy. All edits happen here first, so you can look them over safely.	Only you and Claude.

main	The official copy. Whatever is in `main` is what Netlify publishes.	Everyone who visits the website.

When you are happy with Claude's draft, you say **"push to main"** (or "merge to main", or "publish it"). Claude copies the draft into `main`, Netlify sees the change and publishes it, and a few minutes later it is live.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Nothing goes live until you say so. Claude has been instructed (in a notes file kept with the website, called `CLAUDE.md`) to wait for you to say "push to main" before publishing. If Claude ever seems about to publish without being asked, tell it to stop.

What the website is built from (in one paragraph)

The website is a set of files written in a programming language (TypeScript, using a toolkit called Next.js). You will never need to read them. Most of the words you see on the website, such as events, the announcement bar, menu items, email addresses and service times, live in a handful of tidy "content files", so changes are quick and low-risk. Netlify turns these files into ordinary web pages each time something changes. That process is called a **build**, and putting the result online is called a **deploy**.

Where things are

Thing	Address
Live website	https://vineyardflorence.netlify.app
Claude (to make changes)	https://claude.ai/code
Netlify (publishing, form messages)	https://app.netlify.com — project **vineyardflorence**
GitHub (the files)	https://github.com — repository **vineyard-florence** At the time of writing it sits under the account of the developer who built the site. It should be transferred to a church-owned GitHub account during hand-over (Chapter 2).
Old website (Squarespace)	https://www.vineyardflorence.church — still online until the church's web address is moved (Chapter 14)

CHAPTER 2

Accounts And Access

Before you can make changes, you need to be signed in to three services, and the church needs to own the accounts behind the website.

The accounts you need

Service	What you need	Why
GitHub github.com	A free GitHub account. The website's repository should belong to a **church-owned** account (or a free GitHub "organization" for the church), and each person who edits should be added to it.	Claude works on the files stored here.
Claude claude.ai	A Claude account on a paid plan that includes **Claude Code**. Check claude.com/pricing for current plans.	This is where you ask for changes.
Netlify netlify.com	A Netlify login with access to the church's team and the **vineyardflorence** project. The project should belong to a **church-owned** Netlify team.	To see publishes, undo a bad change, read form messages, and manage the web address.
Church email	An inbox such as info@vineyardflorence.church.	Form notifications and account recovery emails go here.

IMPORTANT: THE CHURCH SHOULD OWN THE ACCOUNTS

Sign up for GitHub and Netlify with a **church email address** (not a personal one) and keep the passwords in a shared church password manager. If the person who looks after the website changes, the church keeps access. Turn on two-step sign-in (also called two-factor authentication) for every account.

Hand-over checklist

When responsibility for the website moves to the church (or from one person to another), work through this list. The outgoing person usually needs to do the steps marked *(outgoing)*.

☐ Create a church-owned GitHub account (or organization) using a church email.

- ☐ *(outgoing)* In GitHub, transfer the `vineyard-florence` repository to the church's account (Repository → *Settings* → *General* → *Danger Zone* → *Transfer ownership*). Alternatively, add the church's account as a collaborator with admin rights.
- ☐ Create a church-owned Netlify team using a church email.
- ☐ *(outgoing)* In Netlify, transfer the **vineyardflorence** project to the church's team, or invite church staff as team members with the Owner role.
- ☐ After any GitHub transfer, open the Netlify project's settings and confirm it is still linked to the repository (look under *Project configuration* → *Build & deploy* → *Continuous deployment*). Reconnect it if needed.
- ☐ Set up email notifications for the website's forms (Chapter 9) and send a test.
- ☐ Sign up for Claude, connect it to GitHub (Chapter 3) and make a small test change.
- ☐ Record every account in the sheet in Appendix C and store passwords in the church password manager.
- ☐ Confirm who controls the church's web address (domain) **vineyardflorence.church** and record it in Appendix C.

GOOD TO KNOW

Moving a repository on GitHub keeps all of its history. Old links to it are automatically redirected. Nothing about the live website changes during a transfer, as long as Netlify stays linked to the repository.

CHAPTER 3

Getting Set Up With Claude

Claude is an AI assistant made by Anthropic. “Claude Code” is the part of Claude that can open a project like this website, edit its files, test the result and publish it when you ask. You use it in a web browser; nothing needs to be installed.

One-time setup

1. **Sign in to Claude.** Go to **claude.ai** and sign in (or create an account with a church email). Make sure your plan includes Claude Code.
2. **Open Claude Code.** Go to **claude.ai/code**. This is the version of Claude that works on projects.
3. **Connect your GitHub account.** Claude needs permission to read and change the website’s files. Go to **claude.ai/connect-github** (or follow the prompt to connect GitHub the first time you start). Sign in to GitHub when asked and approve.
4. **Install the Claude GitHub App on the repository.** From the same page, choose to install the Claude GitHub App and allow it to access the `vineyard-florence` repository. If the repository belongs to a church GitHub organization, an owner of that organization may need to approve this.
5. **Start your first session.** Back at claude.ai/code, start a new session and choose the `vineyard-florence` repository. Claude opens a fresh workspace with a copy of the website’s files.
6. **Try something harmless.** Type: *“Give me a short tour of this website’s pages and tell me where events are stored. Don’t change anything.”* If Claude answers with a list of pages, you are set up.

> **TIP**
>
> Bookmark **claude.ai/code**. That is where you will go every time you want to update the website.

What a session is

Each time you start a new conversation in Claude Code, you get a **session**: a private, temporary workspace with a fresh copy of the website. Inside a session, Claude can:

- read and edit the website's files;
- build the website and open it in a hidden web browser to check that it looks right on a computer and on a phone;
- take screenshots and show them to you;
- save its work to a draft branch in GitHub, and copy it to `main` when you say so;
- check the live website after Netlify publishes.

A session can be picked up again later from your list of sessions. It is still best to start a new session for each new piece of work, such as "update this month's events".

> **CLAUDE READS THE PROJECT NOTES AUTOMATICALLY**
>
> The website includes a file called `CLAUDE.md` that tells Claude how this project works: where content lives, how to build and check the site, and to wait for "push to main" before publishing. You do not need to repeat those instructions. If you want Claude to always do something a particular way, you can ask it to add a line to `CLAUDE.md`.

Sending Claude pictures and files

- **Screenshots** are the easiest way to show Claude what you mean. On Windows press **Windows + Shift + S**; on a Mac press **Cmd + Shift + 4**. Then paste into the chat (Ctrl + V or Cmd + V) or drag the image file into it.
- **Photos and flyers** for the website (event graphics, staff photos) can be dragged into the chat, too. Claude will resize them for the web.
- **Web links** (for example, a registration page on Church Center) can simply be pasted as text.

CHAPTER 4

Your Everyday Workflow

Almost every update follows the same rhythm: ask, review, publish, check.

The six steps in detail

1. **Start a session.** Open claude.ai/code, start a new session and choose the `vineyard-florence` repository.
2. **Describe the change.** Say what you want in everyday words. Be specific about the page, the wording and any dates. Attach a screenshot if you are pointing at something on the site. (Chapter 5 has lots of examples.)
3. **Let Claude work, then read its reply.** Claude edits the files, builds the website, checks it on desktop and phone sizes, and tells you what it did. It often attaches screenshots. Read the summary: it will mention anything it was unsure about or any questions for you.
4. **Ask for adjustments, or keep going.** If something is not quite right, just say so ("make the heading smaller", "use the exact wording from the flyer"). You can make several changes in one session.
5. **Publish.** When everything is right, say **"push to main"**. Claude copies the changes to `main`. Netlify then builds and publishes the website, which usually takes 2–5 minutes. Claude can watch for it and confirm when the change is live.
6. **Check the live website.** Open the page on the live site and press **Ctrl + Shift + R** (Windows) or **Cmd + Shift + R** (Mac) to make your browser fetch the newest version. Check on your phone as well.

What a typical conversation looks like

YOU

"Add the Christmas Eve service to the events page: Thursday, December 24 at 4:00 and 6:00 PM at Vineyard Florence. Here is the flyer." (flyer image attached)

CLAUDE

Claude adds the event, saves the flyer for the web, builds the site and checks the Events page. It replies with what it changed and shows a screenshot of the new event. It may also flag a question, such as: "December 24, 2026 is a Thursday, so the date and day match. Do you want a registration button, or no button?"

YOU

"No button. Looks great — push to main."

CLAUDE

Claude publishes, waits for Netlify to finish, opens the live Events page, and confirms: "It's live. The Christmas Eve service shows on the Events page."

Save credits by grouping changes

Each time something is pushed to `main`, Netlify does a fresh build, and builds use the Netlify plan's monthly credits. You can make as many changes as you like in a session *before* publishing at no extra cost. So, where you can:

- collect several small updates and publish them together (for example, once or twice a week);
- publish urgent fixes (a wrong date, a broken link) right away.

Netlify shows how many credits you have used under the team's usage or billing page (Chapter 8).

Seeing a change before it goes live (optional)

Claude's screenshots are usually enough. If you would like to click around a full test version of the site before publishing, ask:

YOU CAN SAY

"Open a draft pull request so I can see a Netlify preview of these changes."

Netlify then builds a private **deploy preview** at an address like `deploy-preview-12--vineyardflorence.netlify.app`. A preview build also uses credits.

IMPORTANT

A preview link only updates while its pull request is open. Once the pull request is merged or closed, the preview stays frozen at that moment and will not show newer changes. If you need to preview again later, ask Claude for a new pull request and use the new link.

CHAPTER 5

How To Ask Claude For What You Want

Claude understands ordinary language. The clearer and more specific you are, the faster you get exactly what you want.

Seven habits that get great results

1. **Say where.** Name the page (“on the Events page”, “in the menu”, “on the home page, in the Up/In/Out cards”).
2. **Show it.** A screenshot with “this part” removes all guesswork.
3. **Give the exact words.** Paste the wording you want, word for word, for anything public-facing: names, dates, times, prices, emails.
4. **Give complete details for events:** title, date, day of the week, start and end time, place, who it is for, cost, link for registration and an image if you have one.
5. **One idea per message** for big changes. Small changes can be listed together (“three things: 1..., 2..., 3...”).
6. **Ask for a check.** “Show me a screenshot on a phone” or “check every link on that page still works.”
7. **Say when to publish.** Claude will not publish until you say “push to main”.

Good and less helpful requests

Less helpful	Better
“Fix the events.”	“On the Events page, the Men of Courage Breakfast should be Saturday, December 5 at 9:00 AM, not November 7. Keep the same registration link.”
“Make the home page look better.”	“On the home page, the cards under ‘What Is Discipleship?’ feel crowded on a phone. Can you add more space between them? Show me a phone screenshot.”
“Add Pastor Mike.”	“Add a staff member to the Staff page: Mike Smith, Associate Pastor. Bio: (paste bio). Photo attached. Put him after the Lead Pastor.”

“Change the email.”	“Everywhere the website shows info@vineyardflorence.church, change it to office@vineyardflorence.church. List every place you changed it.”

Asking questions is fine too

You do not have to ask for changes only. Claude is also good at explaining. For example:

YOU CAN SAY

“Where does the Contact form send its messages?”

“What would happen if I removed the Latvia card from the Ministries page?”

“Show me the three most recent changes made to the website and what they did.”

“Before you change anything, tell me your plan.”

When Claude asks you something

Claude sometimes stops to ask a question, for example when a date and a day of the week do not match, or when the old wording conflicts with the new. Answer in plain words. If you are not sure, say so: Claude can suggest a sensible choice and explain why.

IMPORTANT: DOUBLE-CHECK FACTS

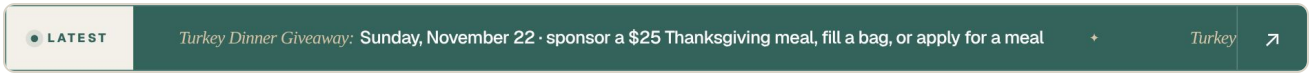
Claude is careful, but it can misread a flyer or make a wrong assumption. Before publishing, read the dates, times, names, prices, phone numbers and email addresses in Claude’s summary or screenshots. These are the details visitors act on.

CHAPTER 6

Common Updates, Step By Step

Ready-made instructions for the updates you will make most often. Copy the wording and change the details.

6.1 The announcement bar (“Latest”)



The announcement bar along the bottom of every page. It scrolls a short message, and clicking it opens a page. While scrolling down, it tucks behind the “Latest” tab.

The bar shows one message on every page. It has an **end date**: after that day it disappears by itself, so an old announcement never lingers.

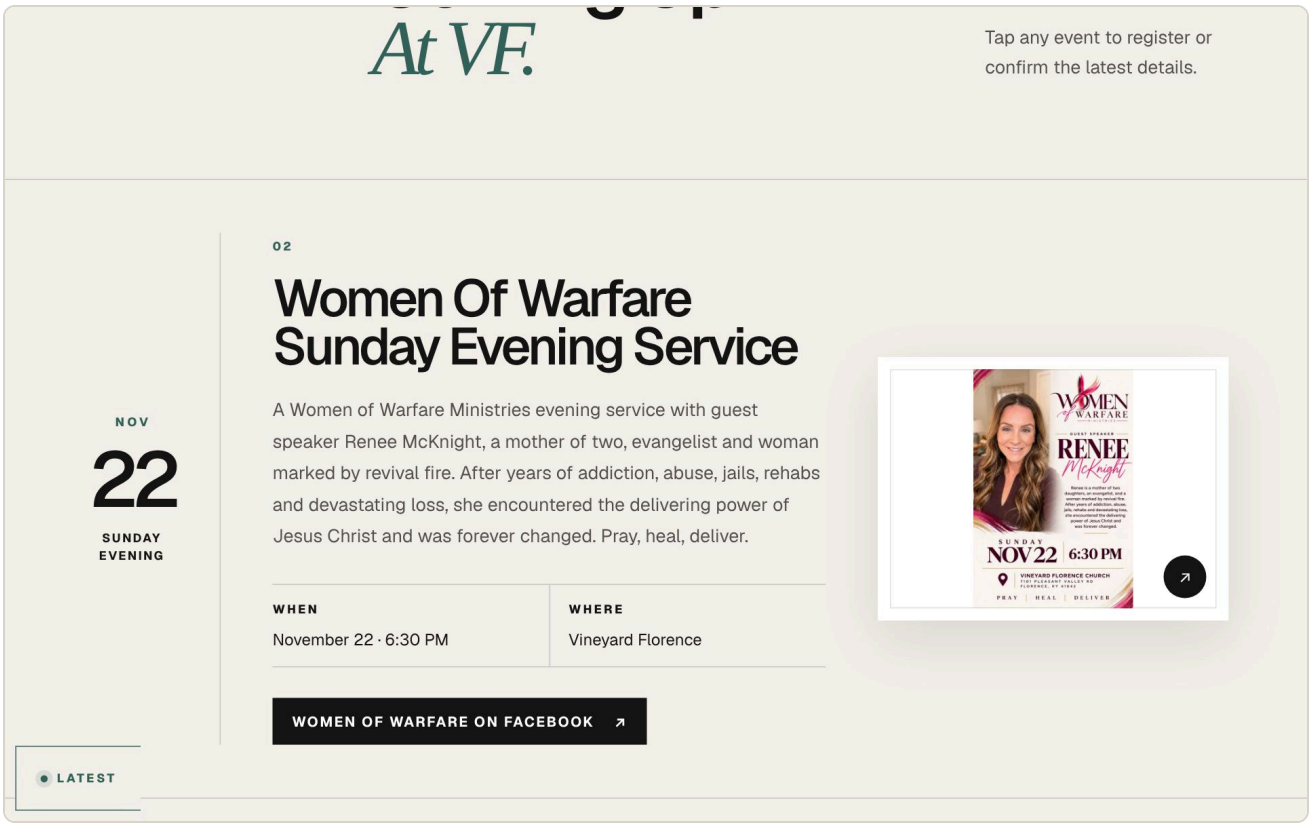
YOU CAN SAY

“Change the announcement bar to: ‘Christmas Eve Services: Thursday, December 24 at 4 & 6 PM.’ Link it to the Christmas Eve event on the Events page and have it disappear after December 24.”

TIP

When the bar disappears after its end date, nothing replaces it until you add a new message. Put a reminder in the church calendar to set the next announcement.

6.2 Add an event



An event on the Events page: the date block, title, description, When/Where details, button and flyer.

Give Claude everything a visitor would need:

- Title, date and day of the week, start time (and end time if known)
- Location (if not the church), who it is for, and the cost
- A short description (or let Claude write one from the flyer)
- The registration link (usually a Church Center page) and the button wording (“Register”, “Sign Up”, “Learn More”)
- The flyer or image

YOU CAN SAY

“Add an event: Women’s Christmas Celebration PJ Party, Sunday, December 6 at 5:30 PM at Vineyard Florence. Description: (paste). Register button → (paste Church Center link). Flyer attached.”

GOOD TO KNOW

Events sort themselves by date. The soonest one appears in the large “Next up” spot automatically, and each event removes itself the day after it ends. You never need to remove past events by hand.

Multi-day events (camps, conferences, mission trips): give the first and last day, so the event stays listed until it has actually ended.

Changing or cancelling an event: “Change the PJ Party to 6:00 PM” or “Remove the Harvest Party from the Events page — it’s been cancelled.”

6.3 Ongoing activities (“Not every good thing fits on one date”)

Below the dated events, the Events page has cards for regular rhythms: Pastries with the Pastors, Prayer Opportunities, the Free Pantry, Baptisms, Women’s Ministry and Men of Courage. These never expire. Ask Claude to update their schedule line, description or link, for example: “On the Baptisms card, change ‘Next: December 6’ to ‘Next: January 3’.”

6.4 Service times, address, phone and email

These are stored once and shown everywhere: the header menu, footer, home page and search. One request updates every page.

YOU CAN SAY

“Our service times are changing to 9:30 and 11:30 AM starting January 4. Update everywhere the site mentions service times, including the Kids page, and list each place you changed.”

6.5 Staff

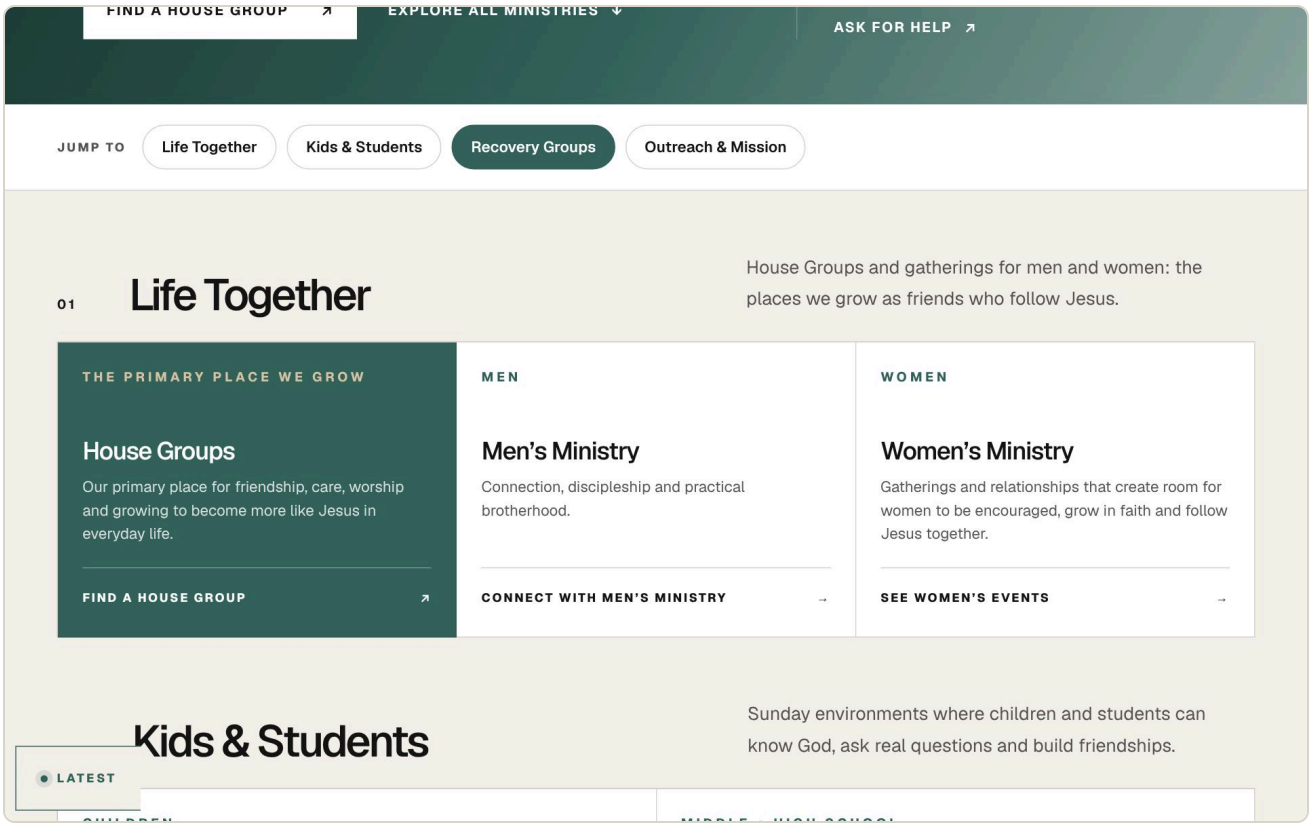
YOU CAN SAY

“Add a staff member: (name), (role). Bio: (paste). Photo attached.”

“Update (name)’s role to (new role).” · “Remove (name) from the Staff page.”

Photos look best when they are clear head-and-shoulders shots, roughly square, at least 800 pixels wide.

6.6 Ministries, recovery groups and their pages



The Ministries page groups ministries under Life Together, Kids & Students, Recovery Groups, and Outreach & Mission, with a "Jump to" bar at the top. Each card is clickable.

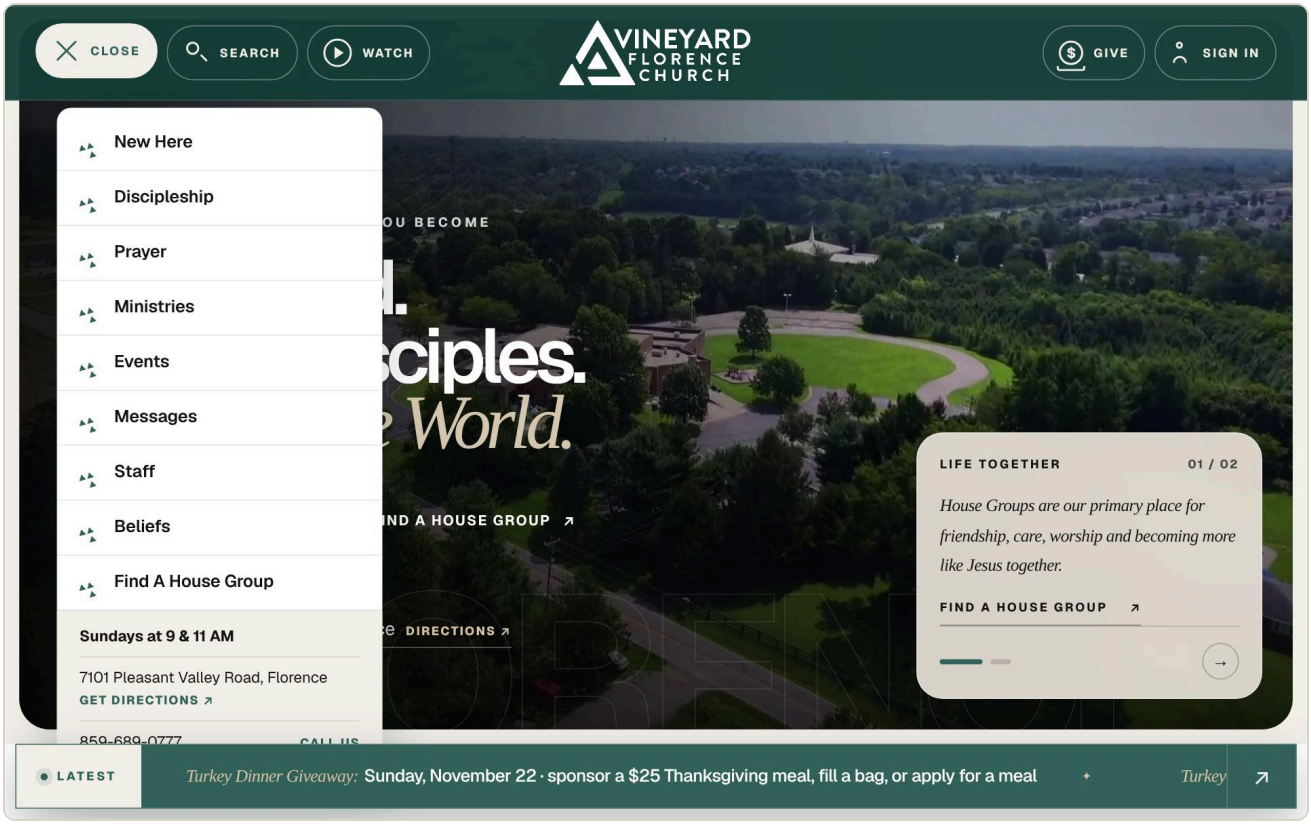
YOU CAN SAY

"Add a ministry card to the Ministries page under Outreach & Mission: (name), (one-sentence description), linking to (link)."

"GriefShare's next session starts Saturday, February 6. Update the GriefShare page."

"Create a page for (ministry) like the Celebrate Recovery page, using this information: (paste)."

6.7 The menu

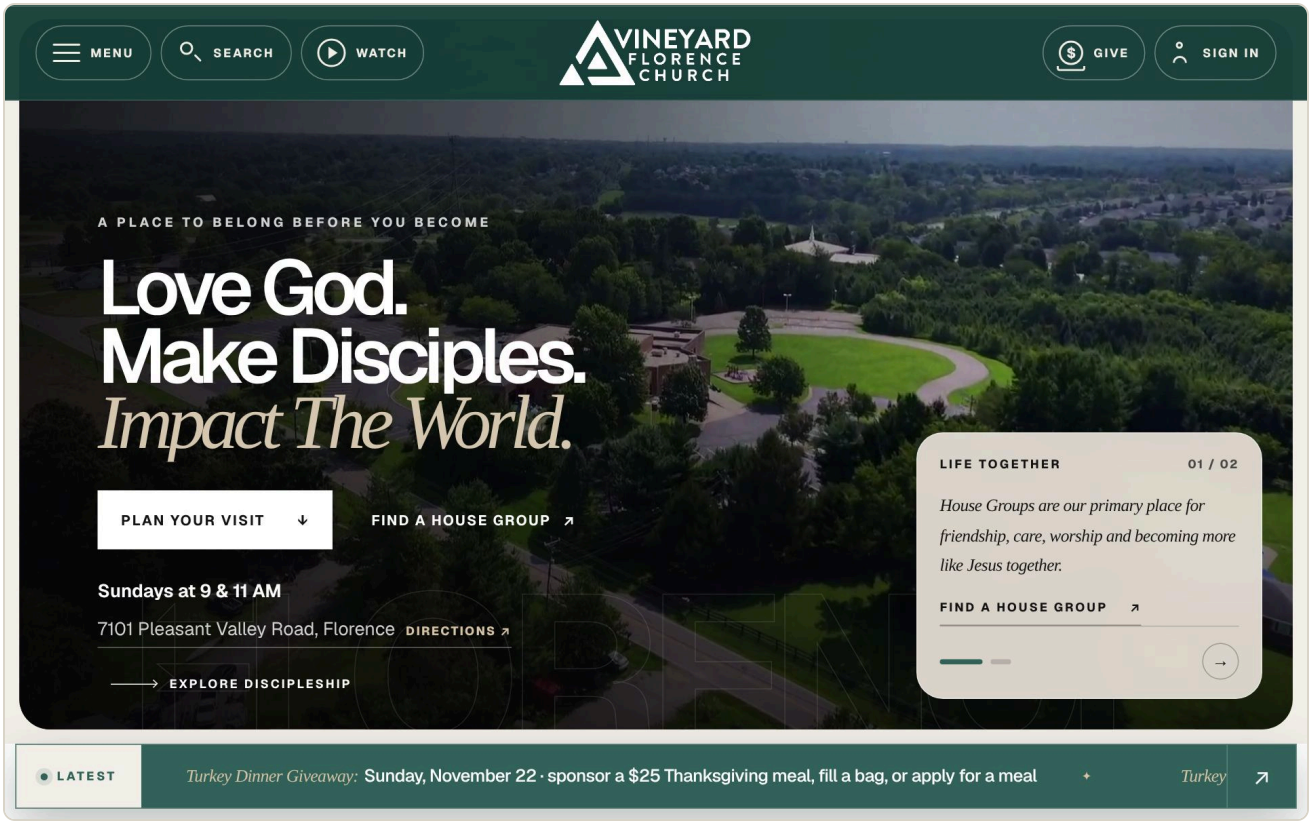


The main menu, opened with the Menu button. It is the same on every page.

YOU CAN SAY

“Add ‘Kids’ to the main menu after Ministries, linking to the Kids page.” · “Remove ‘Staff’ from the main menu but keep it in the footer.”

6.8 Home page



The top of the home page: the hero (headline, Plan Your Visit, service times) and the small rotating card on the right.

Common home page updates include the small rotating card in the hero (“Life Together”, “Coming Up At VF”), the What to Expect section, the frequently asked questions, the Up/In/Out cards, and the photos in the Impact section.

YOU CAN SAY

“Add a third slide to the hero card on the home page: ‘Christmas at VF’ — ‘Join us for Christmas Eve, December 24 at 4 & 6 PM.’ Button ‘See Christmas Services’ → the event on the Events page.”

6.9 Pictures, flyers and documents

- **Attach the actual file** to the chat. Avoid sending links to images on Facebook or Instagram: those links stop working after a while. If you only have a link, tell Claude “download this and save a copy on the website”.
- **Bigger is better.** Send the largest version you have; Claude resizes it for the web.
- **PDFs** (for example, a reading plan or a prayer guide) can be added too: “Add this PDF to the Discipleship resources under ‘Up’ with the title ‘Advent Reading Plan’.”

- **Describe images for people who cannot see them.** Claude adds a short text description (called “alt text”) to each image for screen readers. If an image shows people or key information, check that the description is accurate.

6.10 Kids service times

The Vineyard Kids page shows which Sunday service each age group meets at (for example, Nursery to Preschool at 11 AM only; Elementary at 9 and 11 AM). The home page repeats this in the “Bringing kids?” card and the kids question in the FAQ. If the times change, say: “Update the kids service times everywhere: (new times).”

6.11 Forms

To add a new choice to the Contact form (for example, “Questions About Marriage Ministry”), or to add a field to a sign-up form, ask Claude. A new contact topic becomes its own form in Netlify, so remember to set up its email notification afterwards (Chapter 9).

6.12 Any wording on any page

For anything not listed here, take a screenshot of the area and say what should change:

YOU CAN SAY

“(screenshot) On the Prayer page, change this paragraph to: (new wording).”

CHAPTER 7

Things That Update Themselves

Several parts of the website are designed to look after themselves, so they never show stale information.

What	What it does on its own	What you still do
Events	Sorts events by date, puts the soonest in “Next up”, and hides each event the day after it ends (using Eastern time). This happens in the visitor’s browser, so it works even if nobody publishes anything for weeks.	Add new events. Old ones remove themselves.
Announcement bar	Disappears after its end date.	Set the next announcement.
Messages (sermon archive)	The Messages page shows the church’s Sunday services from YouTube. New services are fetched from the church’s YouTube channel automatically, and the page keeps the last three years.	Nothing, as long as services keep going up on the same YouTube channel. A few times a year, ask Claude to “refresh the saved sermon archive” so older services stay listed (see below).
“Updated” date on the Events page	Shows the date the site was last published.	Nothing.
Copyright year in the footer	Shows the current year.	Nothing.

GOOD TO KNOW: THE SERMON ARCHIVE

YouTube only shares a church’s most recent videos automatically. The website keeps a saved list of older services (a “snapshot”) and adds the newest ones from YouTube on top. If many weeks go by without the snapshot being refreshed, a service that has dropped out of YouTube’s recent list may not appear. Refreshing the snapshot every few months fixes this. If the church ever starts streaming on a different YouTube channel, tell Claude so the website can follow the new channel.

IMPORTANT

Because events disappear automatically, a typo in an event’s date can make it vanish early or never appear. Always check the date in Claude’s summary.

CHAPTER 8

Netlify: Publishing, Undoing And Credits

Netlify is the service that puts the website online. You rarely need to change anything there, but it is where you watch publishes, undo a bad change, read form messages and manage the web address.

Signing in and finding the project

1. Go to **app.netlify.com** and sign in.
2. If you belong to more than one team, choose the church's team.
3. Click the project named **vineyardflorence**. Its overview page shows the live address, the latest publish and links to Deploys, Forms and settings.

Deploys: the list of every publish

Open **Deploys**. Each line is one build of the website, newest at the top, with a status:

Status	Meaning
Building	Netlify is preparing the new version (usually 2–5 minutes).
Published	This version is live. Only one deploy is published at a time.
Failed	Something stopped the build. **The previous version stays live**, so visitors never see a half-finished site. Ask Claude to fix it (see Chapter 12).
Deploy Preview	A private test build for a pull request (Chapter 4). It does not affect the live site.

Undoing a change (rolling back)

If a change goes live and something looks wrong, you can put the previous version back in about a minute, without Claude:

1. In Netlify, open the project and go to **Deploys**.
2. Find the last deploy that you know was good (the one below the latest, usually). Click it.
3. Click **Publish deploy** and confirm. That older version is now live.
4. Then tell Claude what went wrong so it can fix the problem properly: *"The last change broke the Events page, so I rolled back in Netlify. Please fix it, show me, and I'll tell you when to push."*

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> A rollback is a quick fix, not the end of the story. While you are rolled back, the next push to `main` publishes a new version containing everything in `main`, including the change that caused the problem. Make sure Claude has fixed it before pushing again.

Credits and usage

Netlify plans include a monthly allowance (credits) for builds, bandwidth and form submissions. Each push to `main`, and each deploy preview, uses some of it.

- See usage under the team's **Usage** or **Billing** page.
- Group changes and publish them together (Chapter 4).
- If usage gets close to the limit, Netlify sends emails to the team owner. The church can upgrade the plan or wait for the next month.

Settings you should not need to change

The build settings live in a file called `netlify.toml` inside the website's files, so Netlify's *Build settings* page should be left alone. The build command is `npm run build` and the published folder is `deploy`. If anything here ever needs changing, ask Claude to do it in `netlify.toml`.

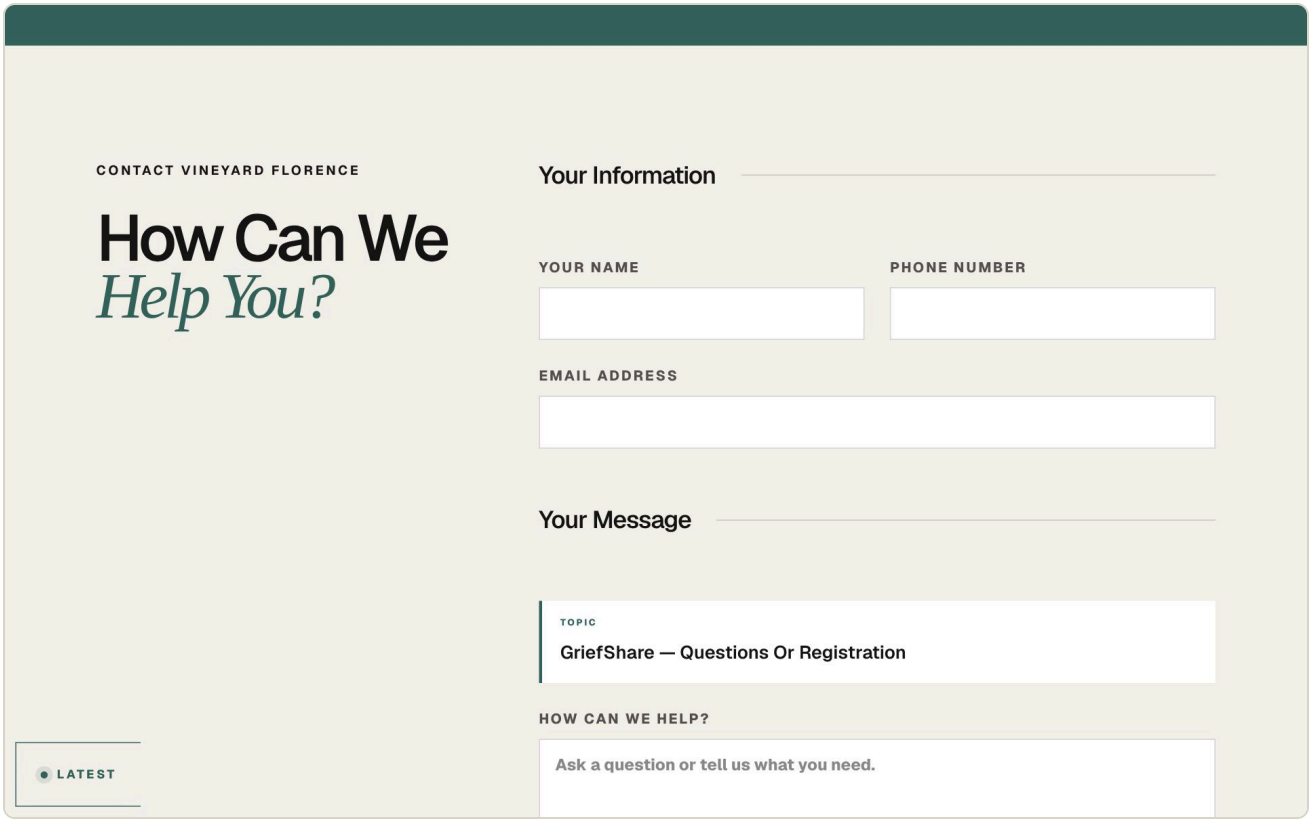
The web address

Under **Domain management** you will see the address `vineyardflorence.netlify.app`. When the church is ready to use **vineyardflorence.church** for the new site, follow Chapter 14.

CHAPTER 9

The Website's Forms

When a visitor fills in a form on the website (a prayer request, a volunteer sign-up, a contact message), Netlify stores the message. Netlify can also email it to the right person, but only after you set that up.



The Contact form. When a visitor arrives from a specific link (here, GriefShare), the topic is filled in for them, and their message goes to that topic's own form in Netlify.

Every form on the website

Form name in Netlify	Where it is	Used for
prayer-request	Prayer Request page	Prayer requests
contact-us-general-questions	Contact page (no topic)	General questions
contact-... (21 topic forms, listed below)	Contact page, opened from a specific button	Topic-specific questions
house-group-interest-signup	Join a House Group page	People looking for a House Group

sunday-volunteer-signup	Serve page	Sunday volunteers (Kids, Students, First Impressions, Media, Worship, Cleaning, Counting)
stock-gift-inquiry	Give Stock page	Gifts of stock
kids-registration	Kids → Pre-Register	Family pre-registration
kids-media-release	Kids → Media Release	Photo permission for children
students-new-student	Students → New Student	New students
students-serve	Students → Serve	Student ministry volunteers
students-newsletter	Students → Newsletter	Newsletter sign-ups
students-media-release	Students → Media Release	Photo permission for students

The 21 contact topics

Each has its own form in Netlify (named `contact-` plus the topic), so each can notify a different person:

Men's Ministry · Help Me Find A Ministry · Help Me Find My Next Step · MERP Partnership Inquiry · Giving To MERP · Question About MERP · I Want To Host A House Group · I Want To Co-Lead A House Group · I Want To Lead A House Group · I Want To Launch A New House Group · House Group Leader Training · I Want To Explore Alpha · I Want To Explore VF Foundations · I Want To Learn About VF Freedom · Vineyard Leadership Essentials · Pastoring, Eldership Or Church Planting · Questions About Baptism · I Want To Serve At VF's Free Pantry · Men Of Courage — More Info · GriefShare — Questions Or Registration · Celebrate Recovery

Reading form messages

1. In Netlify, open the **vineyardflorence** project.
2. Click **Forms** in the project's menu. You will see a list of the forms above.
3. Click a form to see its messages (called *submissions*), newest first. Click one to read it in full.
4. To keep a record, use the option to **download as CSV**, which opens in Excel or Google Sheets.

> **TIP**
>
> Netlify filters suspected spam into a separate *Spam* list on each form. Check it now and then in case a real message was caught by mistake; you can mark it as “not spam”.

Getting form messages by email (set this up!)

Forms do **not** email anyone until notifications are set up. Do this once for each form, choosing the best inbox for each:

1. In the project, go to **Project configuration** (or *Site configuration*) → **Notifications**.
2. Find **Emails and webhooks** → **Form submission notifications** and click **Add notification** → **Email notification**.
3. Choose the **form** (for example, `prayer-request`) and enter the **email address** that should receive it. You can also choose “Any form” to send everything to one inbox.
4. Save. Repeat for other forms that should go to different people (for example, Celebrate Recovery → the recovery pastor; Kids forms → the kids director).
5. **Test it:** fill in the form on the live website with your own details and “TEST” in the message. Check the submission appears in Netlify and the email arrives (check the spam/junk folder too). Then delete the test submission.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Prayer requests and kids registrations contain personal information. Send them only to people who should see them, and do not forward them to large mailing lists.

Changing who gets a form

Edit or delete the notification in the same Notifications page in Netlify. No change to the website is needed and nothing needs to be published.

CHAPTER 10

GitHub: Just Enough To Know

GitHub stores the website's files and a complete history of every change. Claude does all the GitHub work for you, but it helps to know what it is.

The words you may see

Word	Meaning
Repository ("repo")	The project folder that holds all of the website's files. Ours is called `vineyard-florence`.
Commit	A saved change, with a short note describing it. Claude writes clear notes, such as "Events: add Christmas Eve services".
Branch	A separate line of changes: Claude's draft, or `main`.
main	The branch that is published as the live site.
Push	Sending saved changes up to GitHub. "Push to main" = publish.
Merge	Combining one branch into another, for example Claude's draft into `main`.
Pull request	A proposal to merge a branch, which can be reviewed (and previewed on Netlify) first.

Looking at the history

On github.com, open the repository and click the clock icon or the word **Commits**. You will see every change, who made it and when. This is the website's permanent record. Even a large mistake can be undone, because every earlier version is kept. Ask Claude: *"Undo the change called 'Ministries: add The Vinedresser' and show me before I push."*

Should I edit files directly on GitHub?

GitHub lets you edit a file in your browser (the pencil icon). **We recommend asking Claude instead**, because:

- a single missing comma or quotation mark in a content file can make the build fail;
- edits made directly on `main` publish immediately, with no checking;
- Claude checks the result on desktop and phone before anything goes live.

If you do edit on GitHub and the build fails, the old version stays live (Chapter 8), so nothing breaks for visitors. Ask Claude to look at the failed build and fix it.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Do not delete the repository, rename it, or change its *Settings* unless you are following the hand-over steps in Chapter 2. Netlify publishes from this repository, and deleting it would stop the website from updating.

CHAPTER 11

Checking Your Work

A two-minute check after each publish catches almost every problem before visitors do.

Seeing the newest version

Browsers save copies of pages to load them faster, so after a publish you may still see the old page. To fetch the newest version:

- **Windows:** press **Ctrl + Shift + R** (or Ctrl + F5).
- **Mac:** press **Cmd + Shift + R**.
- **Phone:** close the tab and reopen the page, or open it in a private/incognito tab.

After-publish checklist

☐ The page you changed shows the new content.

☐ Dates, times and days of the week are correct.

☐ Buttons and links go to the right place (click each new one).

☐ Images appear and are not blurry or cropped badly.

☐ It looks right on a phone, not only on a computer.

☐ The menu opens and the announcement bar shows the current message.

☐ If you changed a form, submit a test and check it arrives (Chapter 9).

Asking Claude to check for you

YOU CAN SAY

"Check the live site and confirm the new event is showing."

"Check every page on the live site for broken links or missing images and tell me what you find."

"Show me a phone screenshot of the live Events page."

A monthly once-over (15 minutes)

☐ Events: is everything coming up in the next 6–8 weeks on the page?

☐ Announcement bar: is there a current message?

- ☐ Messages page: does it show last Sunday’s service?
- ☐ Forms: any unread submissions or anything sitting in Spam?
- ☐ Staff and ministry pages: any changes in people, times or contacts?
- ☐ Netlify usage: are credits on track for the month?

CHAPTER 12

Troubleshooting

Most problems have a simple cause. Find the closest match below.

What you see	What to do
My change is not on the live site.	1) Did you say “push to main”? If not, Claude has only saved a draft. 2) Wait 5 minutes and hard-refresh (Chapter 11). 3) In Netlify → Deploys, check the latest deploy says *Published*. 4) Ask Claude: “Did my last change reach the live site?”
The latest deploy says “Failed”.	The live site is unchanged and safe. Tell Claude: “The last Netlify deploy failed. Please find out why and fix it.” If Claude cannot see the reason, copy the error text from the failed deploy’s log in Netlify and paste it into the chat.
The live site looks broken.	Roll back in Netlify straight away (Chapter 8), then ask Claude to investigate and fix it before pushing again.
The page looks right on a computer but wrong on a phone.	Send Claude a screenshot from the phone and describe the problem. Ask it to check at phone size before you publish.
An event is missing.	Check its date. Events disappear the day after they end; a wrong year or month makes them vanish early. Ask Claude to check the event’s date.
Form messages are not arriving by email.	1) In Netlify → Forms, check whether the message is there. If it is, the form works and the problem is the email notification: check the notification’s address (Chapter 9) and the recipient’s spam folder. 2) If it is not there, check the form’s Spam list. 3) If still missing, ask Claude to test the form.
A link opens a “page not found” page.	Copy the address of the broken link and the page where you found it, and ask Claude to fix it.
Claude says it cannot access the repository.	Reconnect GitHub at **claude.ai/connect-github** and make sure the Claude GitHub App is installed on `vineyard-florence`. Then start a new session with the repository selected. If the repository was recently transferred, the app may need to be installed again on the new account.

Claude cannot push to main.	Your GitHub account needs permission to change the repository (Write or Admin access). Ask the account owner to check this in GitHub → repository → *Settings* → *Collaborators*.
Claude misunderstood me.	Say so plainly: “That’s not what I meant. Undo that, and instead…” Add a screenshot. Nothing is live until you push to main.
Claude did something I didn’t ask for.	Ask: “List every change you made in this session.” Then: “Undo (the change).” If it has already been published, roll back in Netlify, then ask Claude to remove the change.
The site can’t be reached at all.	Try another device or mobile data. If it works elsewhere, the problem is the local network or browser. If it fails everywhere, check Netlify’s overview page and the status page at netlifystatus.com.
Netlify says credits are running out.	Hold off on non-urgent publishes until next month, group future changes, or upgrade the plan.

TIP

When asking for help, include three things: what you were trying to do, what happened instead, and a screenshot. That works for Claude, Netlify support and any person helping you.

CHAPTER 13

Staying Safe And Good Habits

Protect the accounts

- **Never type a password into the Claude chat.** Claude never needs your GitHub, Netlify or email passwords. If a task needs a special key for another service, Claude will show a secure form for it instead.
- Turn on **two-step sign-in** for GitHub, Netlify and Claude.
- Keep church accounts in a **church password manager**, not in personal notes.
- When someone stops helping with the website, remove their access in GitHub and Netlify.

Protect people's privacy

- Do not paste prayer requests, children's details or other personal information into the Claude chat.
- Only put a person's photo, name or contact details on the website with their permission. For children, check the media release form.
- Be careful with personal email addresses and phone numbers on public pages. A role address (for example, menofcourage@vineyardflorence.church) is better than a personal one.

Habits that prevent problems

- **Read before you publish.** Check dates, days of the week, times, names and links in Claude's summary.
- **Check after you publish** (Chapter 11).
- **Use the exact wording from the source** (flyer, ministry leader, bulletin) for important details.
- **Host your own copies** of images and documents rather than linking to Facebook, Google Drive or someone's personal storage.
- **Keep requests focused.** Start a new session for each separate task.
- **Note big decisions.** If the church makes a rule (for example, "staff photos are always square"), ask Claude to add it to `CLAUDE.md` so it is remembered.

Images and copyright

Only use images the church has the right to use: your own photos, flyers made by the church, or images with permission. Logos of outside organisations (for example, AA or GriefShare) are their trademarks, so check each organisation’s rules before using them.

CHAPTER 14

Moving The Church's Web Address

At the time of writing, vineyardflorence.church still opens the old Squarespace website, and the new site lives at vineyardflorence.netlify.app. This chapter explains, in outline, how to switch the church's address to the new site.

> **IMPORTANT**
>
> Changing a web address affects the website *and possibly the church's email*. Take it slowly, plan it for a quiet weekday, and if you are not confident, ask someone experienced to help, or ask Claude to walk you through each screen.

Before you start

- ☐ Know where the domain **vineyardflorence.church** is registered (for example, Squarespace Domains, GoDaddy or Google Domains) and have the login. Record it in Appendix C.
- ☐ Find out whether the church's email (for example, @vineyardflorence.church) runs through the same company. Write down its current settings, often called "MX records", so email keeps working.
- ☐ Check the new site is complete and every page you need from the old site has been moved.
- ☐ Set up and test form notifications (Chapter 9).

The steps, in outline

1. **Add the domain in Netlify.** Project → **Domain management** → **Add a domain** → enter `vineyardflorence.church`. Netlify shows the settings (DNS records) the domain needs.
2. **Update the domain's DNS settings** at the company where it is registered, using Netlify's instructions. Keep the email (MX) records exactly as they were.
3. **Wait.** Changes can take from a few minutes to 48 hours to reach everyone.
4. **Turn on HTTPS.** Netlify sets up the secure padlock (an SSL certificate) automatically once the domain points at it. Check it under Domain management → HTTPS.
5. **Test** the site at vineyardflorence.church on several devices, send a test form, and send a test email to and from a church address.

6. **Old links.** The new site already redirects some old addresses (for example, the old recovery-group pages and /sermons). Ask Claude to check the most-visited old addresses and add any missing redirects.

7. **Only then**, cancel the old Squarespace website plan. Download anything you want to keep from it first.

CHAPTER 15

Glossary

Term	Plain meaning
Alt text	A short description of an image, read aloud by screen readers for people who are blind or have low vision.
Anchor (#)	A link to a specific section of a page, such as `/events#reset-house`.
Branch	A separate line of changes to the website's files (a draft, or `main`).
Build	Netlify turning the website's files into finished web pages.
Cache	Saved copies of pages kept by your browser. A hard refresh skips them.
Church Center	The church's Planning Center app and website, used for giving, groups and event registration.
Claude / Claude Code	The AI assistant (by Anthropic) you use to make changes. Claude Code is the part that works on projects.
CLAUDE.md	A notes file kept with the website that tells Claude how this project works.
Commit	A saved change with a short description.
Credits	Netlify's monthly usage allowance. Builds use credits.
Deploy	Putting a built version of the website online.
Deploy preview	A private test version of the site, built for a pull request.
DNS	The internet's address book. It connects a web address to the computer that serves it.
Domain	A web address, such as vineyardflorence.church.
GitHub	The online service that stores the website's files and history.
Hard refresh	Reloading a page while skipping saved copies: Ctrl + Shift + R or Cmd + Shift + R.
HTTPS / SSL	The secure connection shown by the padlock in the address bar.
main	The branch that is published as the live website.
Merge	Combining one branch into another.

Netlify	The service that builds and hosts (publishes) the website and collects form messages.
Pull request	A proposal to merge a branch, which can be reviewed or previewed first.
Push	Sending saved changes to GitHub. “Push to main” publishes them.
Repository (repo)	The project folder holding all of the website’s files: `vineyard-florence`.
Rollback	Putting an earlier version of the site back online in Netlify.
Session	One conversation with Claude Code, with its own temporary copy of the website.
Submission	One message sent through a website form.

APPENDIX A

Page-By-Page Map Of The Website

Every page on the website, what is on it, and what is usually updated there.

Page (address)	What's on it	Typical updates
Home /	Hero and service times, rotating card, What to Expect, "What Is Discipleship?" and the Up/In/Out cards, prayer, Impact cards, giving, visit details, FAQ	Hero card slides, FAQ answers, photos
Discipleship /discipleship	The Invitation, Up/In/Out panels with "How We Live It Out", next steps, Multiply, Discovery Groups, resource library	Resources, next-step links
Prayer /prayer	Prayer Hub: prayer times, ways to pray, learning to pray	Prayer times and Zoom link
Prayer Request /prayer-request	Prayer request form	Rarely
Ministries /ministries	Recovery prompt, Jump-to bar, ministry cards in four groups	Add or remove ministries
Recovery pages /ministries/celebrate-recovery, /alcoholics-anonymous, /mens-healthy-sexuality, /griefshare	Meeting times, contacts, descriptions	Session dates, contacts
Vineyard Freedom /ministries/vineyard-freedom	The process, intake questionnaire, after-care resources and PDFs	Resources, contact
Events /events	Next up, upcoming events, ongoing rhythms, Reset House	Weekly: add new events
Messages /messages	Sunday services from YouTube, searchable	Automatic (see Chapter 7)
Staff /staff	Staff photos, roles and bios	People changes
Beliefs /beliefs	Historic Faith links, Mission, GOSPEL values	Rarely

Connect /connect	Next steps for newcomers and ways to get involved	Next-step links
Vineyard Kids /kids (+ /kids/register, /kids/media-release)	Age groups and service times, check-in, forms	Times, age groups
Vineyard Students /students (+ /new, /serve, /newsletter, /media-release)	Weekly rhythm, forms	Times, events
Baptisms /baptisms	About baptism, how to sign up	Next baptism date
Free Pantry /free-pantry	Pantry times and how to serve	Times
MERP /merp	Middle Eastern Refugee Partnership	Updates, giving links
Serve /serve	Sunday volunteer sign-up form	Team list
Join a House Group /join-a-house-group	House Group interest form	Rarely
Give Stock /give-stock	Stock gift inquiry form	Rarely
Contact /contact	Contact form (general or a specific topic)	Topics
Shown on every page	Menu, search, Give menu, footer, announcement bar	Menu items, announcement

APPENDIX B

Things To Say To Claude (Cheat Sheet)

When you want to…	Say…
Get oriented	“Give me a quick tour of where (thing) lives on the website. Don’t change anything.”
Add an event	“Add an event: (title), (day), (date) at (time), at (place). (Description.) Button ‘(label)’ → (link). Flyer attached.”
Change an event	“Change (event) to (new details).”
Remove an event	“Remove (event) from the Events page.”
Update the announcement bar	“Set the announcement bar to ‘(text)’, linking to (page), until (date).”
Change any wording	“(screenshot) Change this to: (new wording).”
Add a staff member	“Add (name), (role), to the Staff page. Bio: (text). Photo attached.”
Change a link	“The (button) on the (page) should go to (link).”
Add a menu item	“Add (page) to the main menu after (item).”
Add a contact topic	“Add a Contact form topic: ‘(topic)’, and a button on (page) that opens it.”
See it first	“Show me desktop and phone screenshots before I publish.”
Preview the whole site	“Open a draft pull request so I can see a Netlify preview.”
Publish	“Push to main.” / “Merge to main.” / “Publish it.”
Confirm it’s live	“Check the live site and confirm the change is there.”
Find out what changed	“List every change you made in this session.”
Undo	“Undo (the change).” / “Put back the (page) as it was before (date).”
Fix a failed build	“The last Netlify deploy failed. Find out why and fix it.”
Check for problems	“Check the live site for broken links and missing images.”
Remember a rule	“Add this to CLAUDE.md so you remember it: (rule).”
Refresh the sermon archive	“Refresh the saved sermon archive from YouTube.”

APPENDIX C

Accounts Record Sheet

Fill this in and keep it somewhere safe (for example, printed in the church office safe). **Do not write passwords here**; keep them in the church password manager.

GitHub

Account / organization that owns the repository: _____

Account email: _____

People with access: _____

Netlify

Team name: _____

Owner email: _____

Plan and monthly credits: _____

Claude

Account(s) used for website edits: _____

Plan: _____

Domain (vineyardflorence.church)

Registered with (company): _____

Account email: _____

Renewal date: _____

Church email provider (if different): _____

Form notifications

Form	Sends to (email)
prayer-request	
contact-us-general-questions	
Contact topics (or list separately)	

house-group-interest-signup
sunday-volunteer-signup
stock-gift-inquiry
kids-registration / kids-media-release
students forms

Other services the website links to

Church Center (giving, groups, registrations) · YouTube (Messages) · Every.org (crypto giving) · Zoom (morning prayer) · Facebook and Instagram

Who manages these: _____